



Touchy Touchy

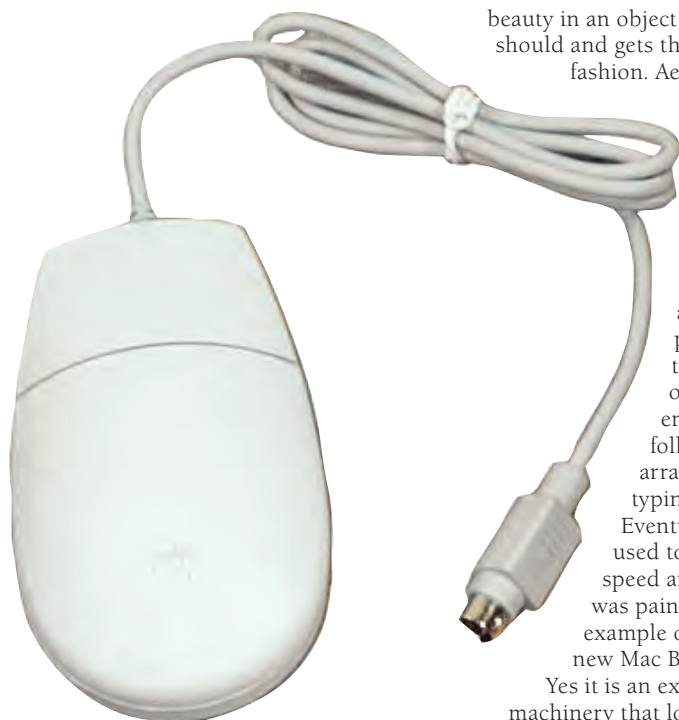
The Razr 2 from Motorola featured an exterior touch screen that launched stuff while sitting in a user's pocket. Highly undesirable.



Slippery controllers

The Wii is surely a revolution, but the glossy controller is famous for slipping out of your hands and heading straight for the screen. Nintendo had to issue latex grips as a quick fix.

Feature



The Mac mouse with its single click button

legion of third party apps that run on top of it or use the API. In fact, they recently had to beef up the level of complexity of their home page. The inference we can make here is that a reasonable amount of complexity might add to the feature set of a product or device, while definitely making it more suitable for so called 'power users' – people that thrive on complexity. Whichever way you look at it, we feel the choice of the level of complexity should be left to the user, much like video games have varying levels of difficulty.

Design before usability

Some designers fall into the trap of making products that pick design aesthetics over usability, comfort and ergonomics. This leads to some serious consequences. We asked Hayley S. Rosen, Industrial Design student at Philadelphia University what she thought. "This is the age-old question of form vs. function", she said. "I feel that the beauty in products is if the form dictates the function. The

beauty in an object is if it works the way it should and gets the job done in a proper fashion. Aesthetics can sometimes be a shell for a great idea." Back in the day Nokia came up with a phone called the Nokia 7600. Sure, the design was unlike anything ordinarily witnessed, but what about usability? The phone had a screen in the centre and two lines of buttons at either end. Because it didn't follow the conventional arrangement of keys, typing became a pain. Eventually users did get used to it but at the cost of speed and the learning curve was painfully steep. Another example of this would be the new Mac Book Pro. Surprised?

Yes it is an excellent piece of machinery that looks great, is fast and very powerful. But the notebook actually hurts like hell when you use it for a while! The edge of the palm rest gouges into your wrist with every passing hour, till ultimately you're left with large suicide-attempt like welts on your wrists.

Stay Updated with Digit

Subscribe to the Digit newsletter to get a daily dose of tech delivered to your inbox. Head over to www.thinkdigit.com/newsletter.php and sign up.

This flop on an otherwise great product probably happened because Apples new design ethos of sharp edges is a little to err sharp for comfort.

Ignoring consumer categories

Very often designers are guilty of designing for those that are aesthetically enlightened i.e. connoisseurs with an eye for design. These designs will surely work in concept awards, but will they work on-road? The choice of words here refers obviously to cars, since they're the most likely to fall prey to this oversight. Traditionally cars have had some of the most beautiful and atrocious designs that have seen the light of day. Cars also ignored for a long while an entire segment of consumers – women. Many women would find that great looking cars were not ergonomic to use. They faced simple issues like chipping fingernails in badly designed door handles to grave ones like fatigue with bulky vehicles. An exception to this norm was the 1990 Mazda Miata –



The MacBook Pro literally has *cutting edge* technology

FOLLOW US ON



DigitIndia

<http://twitter.com/digitindia>



Digit

<http://facebook.com/digitindia>



Digit Club

<http://alturl.com/rznc>



SMS Join DigitIndia to 567678